SUZU TRAVELS · PRIVATE TOUR OF INDIA

Kerala tour — 8 days: Kochi, Munnar, Thekkady and a backwater houseboat

Fort Kochi, Munnar, Thekkady and a night on a houseboat — a sample plan we build from; every night can move.

Day by day

DAY 1 — **Arrive Kochi**

Your driver meets you at Cochin International Airport (name, photo and car number shared with you before the trip). Drive to Fort Kochi, 10 km (6 mi) from Ernakulam town, and settle in. If you land early: a walk to the Chinese fishing nets at sunset.

DAY 2 — **Fort Kochi and Mattancherry**

A day on foot and by car: the Chinese fishing nets at Vasco da Gama Square, St. Francis Church — India's oldest European church — Santa Cruz Basilica, Mattancherry Palace and the Jewish Synagogue. In the evening, a Kathakali performance (we book the seats; arrive early to watch the make-up).

DAY 3 — **Kochi → Munnar**

About 119 km (74 mi) from the airport side of the city, climbing through rubber and spice country into tea. Munnar sits at 1,600 m (5,250 ft) where three rivers meet; tea was first planted here in 1880. Afternoon walk among the tea bushes; nights can be close to freezing in winter — pack a layer.

DAY 4 — **Munnar: tea, tahr and the high road**

Eravikulam National Park (97 sq km / 37 sq mi), home of the endangered Nilgiri tahr, beneath Anamudi, at 2,695 m (8,842 ft) the highest peak in South India. A tea-estate visit to see how the leaf becomes your morning cup. The rare Neelakurinji flowers here only once in twelve years — ask us whether your year is one.

DAY 5 — **Munnar → Thekkady**

A half-day drive through the cardamom hills to Thekkady, at 900–1,800 m (2,950–5,900 ft). The slopes grow cardamom, pepper, vanilla, cinnamon, clove, nutmeg, tea and coffee; a spice-garden walk in the afternoon explains what you have been smelling all day.

DAY 6 — **Thekkady: Periyar Tiger Reserve**

The reserve covers 777 sq km (300 sq mi) of forest around a 26 sq km (10 sq mi) lake. A two-hour boat trip, arranged by the Kerala Tourism Development Corporation, is the classic way to watch elephants, gaur, sambar and otters from a safe distance; March and April give the best chances as animals come to the water. Tigers are rarely seen — we never promise one.

DAY 7 — **Thekkady → the backwaters, houseboat night**

125 km (78 mi) west, about 3 hours, to Alappuzha — "the Venice of the East". Board a kettuvallam, a traditional rice barge rebuilt as a houseboat with bedrooms, a living deck and a kitchen; your crew cooks lunch, dinner and breakfast on board. The boat moors for the night on the backwaters, a 900 km (560 mi) network of canals, rivers and lakes around Kuttanad, one of the few places in the world below sea level.

DAY 8 **Backwaters → Kochi airport**

Breakfast on the water, then about 83 km (52 mi) and 2 hours to Cochin International Airport. Flying on to Delhi for the Golden Triangle, or home? We plan the departure time around your flight, with a margin.

What is included — and what is not

- **Included.** Private air-conditioned car and the same English-speaking driver for all 8 days, fuel, tolls, parking and state taxes; 6 hotel nights with breakfast in the tier you choose; 1 houseboat night with all meals on board; airport pick-up and drop.
- **Not included.** International and domestic flights, the India e-Visa, entry tickets (Eravikulam, the Periyar boat, museums, Kathakali), lunches and dinners off the boat, tips. We can pre-book the tickets and the Kathakali seats in the same quote.
- **Cars.** Sedan for 2–3 travellers, SUV for 4–6, a minibus for groups. The hill roads to Munnar and Thekkady are narrow and winding — we use SUVs there for families.
- **How Kerala is run.** Our team runs North India from Himachal; in Kerala we arrange the car, hotels and houseboat with local operators we have worked with and stay your single point of contact from the first message to the airport drop. Who you deal with is a registered travel agent with a real office, not a marketplace.

Prices

Kerala — 8 days / 7 nights (this itinerary)	**on request**	Private car and driver throughout, 6 hotel nights with breakfast, 1 houseboat night with meals, airport transfers; tickets and Kathakali on request
Golden Triangle — 4 days (Delhi, Agra, Jaipur)	**from US$299**	Per person, two sharing: private air-conditioned car and driver, hotels with breakfast, airport pick-up and drop, local guides at the main monuments

Prices are per person in US dollars, indicative, and confirmed on your quote. You receive a day-by-day plan with a US-dollar total and what it covers before you pay anything.

How booking works

20% deposit locks your dates and price; full refund if cancelled within 48 hours of paying; balance before the trip; pay by card via Razorpay (international cards accepted) or PayPal.

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